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Write your **student number** in the boxes above. **Letter**

Music Composition

Question and Answer Book

VCE Examination – Wednesday 29 October 2025

- Reading time is **15 minutes**: 11.45 am to 12 noon
- Writing time is **1 hour**: 12 noon to 1.00 pm

Materials supplied

- Question and Answer Book of 16 pages

Instructions

- All your work, including rough work, will be considered for assessment.
- You may write at any time during the playing of the audio recording.

Students are **not** permitted to bring mobile phones and/or any unauthorised electronic devices into the examination room.

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4 questions (75 marks) ____ 3–14

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Instructions

- Answer all questions in the spaces provided.
- Write your responses in English.
- An audio recording will play continuously for the duration of writing time.

Question 1 (19 marks)

Work: 'Let's Go to the Beach'

Composer/Creator: Banoffee

Performer: Banoffee

Album: *Banoffee* (Two Bright Lakes, 2014)

First playing (1′28″) – 15 seconds of silence
Second playing (1′28″) – 30 seconds of silence
Third playing (1′28″) – 1 minute of silence
Fourth playing (1′28″) – 1 minute of silence
Fifth and final playing (1′28″) – 2 minutes 30 seconds of silence

The structure of this excerpt could be described as follows.

Time code	Section	Description
0:00	1	introduction
0:31	2	verse
1:04	3	chorus

a. Identify the first three instruments/sound sources in the order in which they enter. 3 marks

Instrument/Sound source 1 _____

Instrument/Sound source 2 _____

Instrument/Sound source 3 _____

Question 1 continues on the next page.

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b. Describe three ways repetition is used throughout the excerpt. 6 marks

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Do not write in this area.

c. Select two elements of music from the list below and explain how each is used to create variation.

- texture
- duration
- tone colour

10 marks

Element 1

Element 2

Do not write in this area.

Question 2 (20 marks)

Work: Symphony No. 3 in C minor, Op. 78 'Organ Symphony': IV. Maestoso

Composer/Creator: Camille Saint-Saëns

Performers: Chicago Symphony Orchestra

Conductor: Daniel Barenboim

Organist: Gaston Litaize

Album: *Saint-Saëns: Symphony No. 3* '*Organ*' (Deutsche Grammophon, 1976)

First playing (2′03″) – 15 seconds of silence
Second playing (2′03″) – 30 seconds of silence
Third playing (2′03″) – 1 minute of silence
Fourth playing (2′03″) – 1 minute of silence
Fifth and final playing (2′03″) – 2 minutes 30 seconds of silence

The structure of this excerpt could be described as follows.

Time code	Section	Instrumentation
0:00	1	orchestra plus featured instrument 1
0:33	2	orchestra plus featured instruments 1 and 2
1:12	3	orchestra plus featured instrument 1
1:49	4	layered entries

a. **i.** Identify featured instrument 1 in Sections 1, 2 and 3. 1 mark

ii. Identify featured instrument 2 in Section 2. 1 mark

iii. Identify one instrument in Section 4 that has **not** already been identified in **part a.i** or **part a.ii**. 1 mark

Do not write in this area.

b. Describe the string melody in Section 2.

In your response, you may consider concepts of melody such as intervals, contour, tonality, range, phrasing and register. 4 marks

c. Describe the texture in Section 4. 4 marks

Question 2 continues on the next page.

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d. Using the table below, select three elements of music and discuss how each element is used to create contrast between Section 3 and one other section.

You may not discuss the same element more than once.

You may discuss the same section – 1, 2 or 4 – more than once. 9 marks

Element of music	Other section	Discussion
Select one (✓) ☐ tone colour ☐ duration ☐ articulation ☐ dynamics ☐ texture	**Select one (✓)** ☐ Section 1 ☐ Section 2 ☐ Section 4	
Select one (✓) ☐ tone colour ☐ duration ☐ articulation ☐ dynamics ☐ texture	**Select one (✓)** ☐ Section 1 ☐ Section 2 ☐ Section 4	
Select one (✓) ☐ tone colour ☐ duration ☐ articulation ☐ dynamics ☐ texture	**Select one (✓)** ☐ Section 1 ☐ Section 2 ☐ Section 4	

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Question 3 (18 marks)

Work: 'Home at Last'

Composers/Creators: Walter Becker and Donald Fagen

Performers: Steely Dan

Album: *Aja* (ABC Records, 1977)

First playing (1′32″) – 15 seconds of silence
Second playing (1′32″) – 30 seconds of silence
Third playing (1′32″) – 1 minute of silence
Fourth playing (1′32″) – 1 minute of silence
Fifth and final playing (1′32″) – 2 minutes 30 seconds of silence

The structure of this excerpt could be described as follows.

Time code	Section	Description	Instrumentation
0:00	1	verse	lead vocals, rhythm section (drums, piano, vibraphone, bass, guitar, keyboard), horns (saxophones, brass)
0:15	2	chorus	lead vocals, backing vocals, rhythm section, horns
0:45	3	interlude	rhythm section, guitar, horns
1:00	4	**transition**	rhythm section, synthesiser, horns
1:15	5	synthesiser solo	synthesiser, rhythm section

a. In Section 2/chorus, the main melodic material is delivered by the lead vocals.
Identify two other melodic instruments in this section. 2 marks

Melodic instrument 1 _____

Melodic instrument 2 _____

Question 3 continues on the next page.

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b. Describe two roles of the guitar in Section 3/interlude. 4 marks

Role 1

Role 2

c. Explain how duration (rhythm) and pitch (harmony) are used to create **transition** between Sections 3 and 5.

In your response, you may refer to other elements of music. 12 marks

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Question 4 (18 marks)

Work: 'Aey Nehin'

Composer/Creator: Arooj Aftab

Performers: Arooj Aftab, Petros Klampanis, Gyan Riley, Kaki King, Maeve Gilchrist, Jamey Haddad

Album*: Night Reign* (Verve Records, 2024)

First playing (1′26″) – 15 seconds of silence

Second playing (1′26″) – 30 seconds of silence

Third playing (1′26″) – 1 minute of silence

Fourth playing (1′26″) – 1 minute of silence

Fifth and final playing (1′26″) – 2 minutes 30 seconds of silence

The structure of this excerpt could be described as follows.

Time code	Section	Description	Instrumentation
0:00	1	verse	vocal solo with instrumental accompaniment
1:04	2	instrumental	instrumental solos

a. Describe the use of articulation in Section 1/verse. 3 marks

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b. Discuss how character is created throughout this excerpt.

In your response, refer to repetition and two elements of music from the list below.

- texture
- dynamics
- pitch
- tone colour
- duration

15 marks

Element 1 _____

Element 2 _____

Question 4 continues on the next page.

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End of examination questions

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